

HORIZON TECH

Training & Development Policy

Learning Pathways, Certification Support & Leadership Programmes

Version 2.0 | Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Classification: Confidential — Internal Use Only

Department: Learning & Development (L&D)

This policy covers: Annual Learning Budgets, Mandatory Compliance Training, Internal Learning Paths, External Conference Attendance, Certification Reimbursement, Mentorship Programme, and Leadership Academy.

1. Annual Learning Budget Allocation

1.1 Budget by Grade

Each employee receives an annual learning budget that may be used for external courses, certification exams, online learning platforms, and approved books. Budgets reset on January 1 each year and do not carry over. Unused budgets cannot be claimed as cash.

Grade	Annual Budget (USD)	Paid Training Days	Platform Subscription
G1 – New Hire (0–1 yr)	\$2,500	5 days	Included
G2 – Specialist (1–5 yrs)	\$5,000	8 days	Included
G3 – Lead / Supervisor	\$8,000	10 days	Included
G4 – Manager	\$10,000	12 days	Included
G5 – Senior Manager / Director	\$12,000	15 days	Included

1.2 Approved Expenditure Categories

The following categories are eligible for reimbursement from the learning budget:

- Online course fees (Coursera, Udemy Business, LinkedIn Learning, Pluralsight).
- Professional certification exam fees and official prep materials.
- In-person instructor-led training from accredited providers.
- Technical books and reference materials (up to \$200/year).
- Workshop or bootcamp registration fees.

All expenditures require pre-approval via the L&D; request form on the Horizon Portal. Post-purchase reimbursement without prior approval may be denied.

2. Mandatory Compliance Training

2.1 Annual Mandatory Modules

All employees must complete the following compliance training modules annually. Completion is tracked automatically in the HR Learning Management System (LMS). Non-completion by the deadline may result in a disciplinary note on the employee's record.

Module	Audience	Format	Annual Deadline
Information Security Awareness	All staff	Online (1 hr)	31 March
Data Protection & GDPR Principles	All staff	Online (1.5 hrs)	31 March
Anti-Bribery & Corruption	All staff	Online (1 hr)	30 June
Workplace Harassment Prevention	All staff	Online (1 hr)	30 June
Fire Safety & Emergency Procedures	All staff	In-person (2 hrs)	30 September
Manager Essentials (people managers only)	G3 and above	Online (3 hrs)	31 March
AI Ethics & Acceptable Use	All staff	Online (45 min)	31 March

3. Internal Learning Paths

3.1 Functional Tracks

Horizon Tech maintains curated learning paths for each functional area. Learning paths consist of a structured sequence of internal workshops, e-learning modules, job-shadowing opportunities, and stretch assignments. Employees should discuss their learning path with their line manager during the annual OKR-setting cycle.

Track Name	Target Audience	Duration	Key Outcomes
Engineering Excellence	Software Engineers	6 months	System design, code quality, DevOps
Product Mastery	Product Managers	4 months	Roadmapping, metrics, stakeholder mgmt
Data & Analytics	Analysts, Data Engineers	5 months	SQL, Python, BI tools, ML basics
People Leadership	Team leads, managers	6 months	Coaching, feedback, HR basics
Client Solutions	Sales, Pre-sales, CS	3 months	Consultative selling, CRM, negotiation
Finance & Compliance	Finance, Legal, Risk	4 months	IFRS, local tax law, audit basics

4. External Conference & Event Attendance

4.1 Eligibility & Approval

Employees may apply to attend external industry conferences, summits, and professional events as part of their annual development plan. Attendance must be directly relevant to the employee's role and approved by the line manager and department head. Costs are charged to the employee's learning budget.

- Applications must be submitted at least 30 days before the event.
- Employees must share a written summary of key takeaways within 10 days of returning.
- International conferences also require sign-off from the department's VP or equivalent.

5. Certification Reimbursement & Exam Policy

5.1 Certification Tiers

Horizon Tech categorises professional certifications into three tiers based on strategic alignment and market value. Reimbursement rates differ by tier:

Tier	Examples	First Attempt	Retake (max 1)	Study Leave
Tier 1 — Strategic	AWS Solutions Architect, PMP, CFA, CISA	100%	50%	Up to 3 days
Tier 2 — Functional	Google Analytics, Scrum Master, ITIL	100%	25%	Up to 2 days
Tier 3 — Foundational	Microsoft Office Specialist, CompTIA A+	80%	Not covered	None

6. Mentorship Programme

6.1 Programme Structure

The Horizon Tech Mentorship Programme pairs junior and mid-level employees (mentees) with senior professionals (mentors) across the organisation. The programme runs in two cohorts per year (February and August) and lasts six months per cohort. Participation is voluntary for mentees and recognised as a leadership contribution for mentors.

- Mentor–mentee pairs meet for a minimum of one hour per month.
- Both parties complete a mid-programme check-in form submitted to L&D.;
- Mentors at G4+ who complete a full cohort receive a formal recognition note in their HR record.

7. Leadership Academy

7.1 Programme Overview

The Horizon Tech Leadership Academy is a selective 12-month programme designed to accelerate the development of high-potential employees (rated 4 or 5 in their most recent review) identified for future senior leadership roles. The programme combines executive coaching, action learning projects, external faculty sessions, and peer networking.

7.2 Nomination & Selection

Nominations for the Leadership Academy open annually in October. The selection committee comprises the Chief People Officer, two business unit heads, and an external facilitator. Final cohort size is capped at 20 participants per year. Nominees must be at grade G3 or above, have at least two years of tenure, and have received no active disciplinary warnings.